

COMBAT MINDSET — THE WAY FORWARD

Defining, developing and assuring the human-performance capability Army requires to remain effective in combat.

HARDER TO KILL

Proposed Warfighter Focus line — subject to sponsor endorsement

WARFIGHTING IMPERATIVE

Army requires individuals, teams and leaders who remain effective and act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically under the threat, adversity and uncertainty of combat.

COMBAT MINDSET

COMBAT-SPECIFIC EXPRESSION

The individual and collective readiness and disposition to remain effective and act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically under the threat, adversity and uncertainty of combat in order to achieve the mission.

▼ enabled by

PERFORMANCE UNDER PRESSURE

ENABLING HUMAN-PERFORMANCE CAPABILITY

The trainable individual and collective human-performance capability to prepare for, maintain effective performance through, adapt within and recover from pressure.

PREPARE

PERFORM

ADAPT

RECOVER

Applicable across combat, command, crisis response, training, garrison leadership and high-risk technical activity.

▼ developed and organised through

ARMY COMBAT MINDSET FRAMEWORK

ORGANISING MODEL

The organising model through which Army defines, develops, integrates and assures the capabilities, products and governance arrangements that enable Combat Mindset.

Organises: definitions · desired outcomes · capability strands · developmental progression · products and methods · delivery · governance · evidence · assurance

▼ delivered through

GOVERNANCE AND ASSURANCE — INTERIM MODEL

Army Sponsor — Strategic sponsorship and policy direction

COMDT ACS — Interim capability integrator

ACS — Framework development and delivery coordination

Human Performance Cell — COGCON product steward; performance-cognition adviser

Domain advisers — NZDF Psychology, ILD, doctrine, physical performance

Delivery — Training establishments, units, existing instructors

Assurance — Layered: doctrine, evidence, professional, learning, delivery, operational

PROGRAMME OF WORK — 2026

DEFINE

MAP

DEVELOP

VALIDATE

TRIAL

REPORT

Phase 4 is a limited COGCON MVP integration trial, subject to capacity. Report back November 2026: Framework v1.0, capability and product map, implementation plan.

THE OUTCOME

A coherent, joined-up and assured Army approach that deliberately develops individuals, teams and leaders who remain effective under pressure and are prepared to act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically in combat.

CAPABILITY STRANDS — WHAT WE BUILD

Leadership

Mental skills

Performance cognition

Resilience & recovery

Physical performance

Professional identity & values

Individual & collective exposure to pressure

TRAINING PRODUCTS AND METHODS — HOW WE BUILD IT

NZALC Performance Under Pressure package

NZDF Psychology products

COGCON MVP

Developmental product — performance-cognition strand

Scenario & experiential training

Physical conditioning

Structured reflection & recovery

Other products identified in Phase 1 mapping

COGCON develops selected elements of Performance Under Pressure — not a complete Combat Mindset programme or a validated operational-readiness measure.

Prepare → Perform → Recover · Lead Self → Lead Teams → Lead Leaders → Lead Systems